Statement

Sensitive

Statement in the matter of R v Vida Reid

Name	Terri Susan Roberts
Occupation	Support Coordinator
Address	Known to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS)
Date	11 October 2022

STATES:

1. This statement made by me accurately sets out the evidence that I would be prepared, if necessary, to give in court as a witness.

2. My full name is Terri Susan Roberts.

3. My residential address is known to the National Disability Insurance Scheme.

4. I know Vida Reid.

5. I first met Vida Reid in 2019. At the time I was working for APM as a senior case manager. Vida was employed as a business manager that was transferred from the Belmont office to my office in Armadale. We worked together in 2019, until she went to APM Local Area Coordinator.

6. I didn't hear from Vida again, until October 2020 where she has contacted me via Facebook Messenger asking me how I was and telling me about her new business. She mentioned that she had a new NDIS business. At the time I didn't know much about the NDIS.

7. We keep in contact regularly between October and December. Eventually she called me on the phone and offered me a full time job. I can't recall the name of the position, but it was a managerial role for a team. I told her I wasn't keen and

referred her to Leah Norman, who we also worked with at APM. To my knowledge Leah then gained employment as a Services Manager.

8. Sometime in January 2021, I met with Vida at the Dome Café in Byford where she offered me the position of support coordinator and told me she would match my current salary and a do a bonus structure quarterly.

9. I have remained at APM till February 2021, where afterwards I accepted the position working for Vida as a support coordinator. I received my contract sometime after and saw that the role was a support worker/support coordinator. I called Vida about this and told her that I didn't want to be a support worker. She told me that was just the requirements of what she needed to put in the contract so that the NDIS could help her create her business. At this point in time I still did not know the name of the business as the contract appeared as though I was contracted to her. Vida also informed me that I needed an ABN to start work, I have gotten an ABN sometime later.

10. In February 2021, I commenced working for Vida. Sometime after I started working for Vida, I became aware that the name of the business was Forward Focused Group.

11. The first two days of my employment was recovery coach training, this was under her husband Simon's name for him to get the ticket. For the first few months we worked out of Vida and Simon's home in Mt Richon.

12. My duties were never clearly defined. Vida never educated us on the NDIS and instead she would stand in front of us, take our keyboards and tell us to watch and learn. One day I might be in the car for eight hours a day looking for SIL accommodation, and other days it would be in the office reading reports or doing various different training programs such as DSC support coordination.

13. In late March 2021, Vida asked all staff working for her to copy signatures from old service agreements onto new service agreements for participants. This did not sit well with me and made me feel uncomfortable. I was too fearful to say anything to

Vida about this as I had witnessed her belittle people on the team, and publicly humiliate staff on group chats.

14. Just prior to Vida opening the business office in Armadale in either April or May of 2021, Vida had a friend called Francesco from Modplex Construction that she wanted to go into business with. Vida had wanted to send referrals to him for home modifications for participants. These invoices were coming through at up to $7500 when the amount permitted in the participant's plan was $500. I questioned this with Vida and she told me it was cheap, and that the prices of the invoices were normal. Plan managers would contact me and tell me that the prices were not stated in the plan. Vida would take my computer and then write a response to them on by behalf from my computer. I would freeze and was too scared to say or do anything. Vida made me feel very intimidated and I was never sure of what lengths she would go to.

15. Vida would expect her staff to attend social events and if you didn't attend, she would remove you out of the work group chat and create a new group chat with other members to talk badly about you.

16. In June 2021, Vida approached Leah Norman and I at the Metro Hotel and asked us to go into business with her to create sister companies. She said that Leah would do one and I would do one, we didn't discuss it beyond that at that time.

17. Vida would discuss the idea daily after that.

18. In June 2021, my fiancé Pieter and I were invited to Vida's house for drinks and to create and discuss the business. Pieter was never meant to be involved. It was proposed that night by Vida. She said that you need a Director to create a business and it couldn't be Simon as he is a conflict of interest. She said she only needed Pieter's name for the sake of opening the business and he wouldn't need to do anything. Pieter has agreed to this. We both had very little understanding of what this meant.

19. That night we decided that the name of the business would be Infinity Living Options.

20. To my knowledge Vida organised everything and organised for herself to have 51% of shares of the business with me having 49%. Originally she suggested 50/50, but decided that because she was funding the start-up costs and business administration that she would get 51%.

21. Sometime after, we went to ANZ in Armadale to open a bank account for the business. Vida needed Pieter and my signature to open the company bank account. Pieter attended sometime after to sign.

22. Sometime after this, Vida put a non-qualified recovery coach in a Stayz Air BnB House in Fremantle with NDIS participant Levi Kenyon. One night Levi was showing signs of psychosis and was under the influence of alcohol and returned home where the unqualified coach was present. Levi has attempted to stab the coach. The coach then left the participant in the house in his own. To my knowledge, no action was taken to contact police or an ambulance. After I found out about the situation, I pulled the recovery coach into the office, recorded the conversation on my surface pro and was accompanied by Luke Hazelwood. After this conversation I contacted the Police for a voluntary admittance to mental health for Levi. Levi was self-managed and Vida would access his PRODA account and approve all of his payments.

23. Vida would purchase goods for participants such as washing machines and mobile phones and claim it as an act of goodwill however would charge it to the participant's plan.

24. I am aware that Vida would also receive 20% of all of her referrals to Modplex Constructions. Vida would openly discuss this in the office and around Francesco.

25. Vida would also use Simon as a recovery coach for participants, even though he was not completely qualified with the exception of a two day course. I am aware

that one of the participants that Simon was a recovery coach for was David Gorman.

26. In October 2021, I am aware that Vida had a facelift. I am aware of this because she made her booking public in the group chat. I was given directive from Simon to see Vida for a plan review. The plan review was via the phone. She informed the NDIS that she had fallen over, hit her head and had to get multiple stitches. She said this was the result of a MS episode and needed more funding in her plan. The planner told her that she needed evidence. Vida stated that she had a medical report from Registered Nurse Ikram from Empowering Community Disability Services that had details of the incident.

27. I decided in October 2021 that I was going to resign. I felt that Vida put participants at risk, bullied and harassed staff members, the business had unethical practices and unpaid bonuses. I submitted my resignation on a Sunday and when I attended work on the Monday, Vida had packed up all of my belongings and walked me out of the office.

28. The same day I resigned Leah has contacted me and told me to check the bank account for the company and my emails as she said that Vida had been hacking personal emails.

29. I have logged on to the ANZ banking app on my phone and checked the account. I saw that just under $59,000 was transferred out. I called ANZ, and it took 24 hours for them to trace it. I was informed by ANZ that it had been deposited into the bank account for Forward Focused Group.

30. After this, Pieter has contacted Vida and instructed her to put the money back in the bank account and halt the business. Vida has then instructed Pieter to correspond only with her legal team.

31. I contacted the ANZ Fraud Team and Pieter also contacted Armadale Police and provided a statement.

32. I started to receive multiple calls from people that worked in the disability sector, expressing their concern that Vida was calling everyone directly and alleging that I was sacked for fraudulent activities and that the NDIS were investigating me for fraud. I am aware that Vida also called every participant and informed them of the same information.

33. I have since, had no direct communication with Vida or Simon Reid

This statement is true to the best of my knowledge and belief. I have made this statement knowing that, if it is tendered in evidence, I will be guilty of a crime if I have wilfully included in the statement anything that I know to be false or that I do not believe is true.

Signature _____
Terri Susan Roberts

Statement taken and signature witnessed by me about 7:40pm on 11 October 2022 at Baldivis in Western Australia.

Signature _____
Sian Harsley